Post & Core: Metal Post

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Rebuilding a Tooth That Has Lost Significant Structure

When a tooth is badly damaged by decay, fracture or previous dental treatment, there may not be enough natural tooth structure left to support a crown. A metal post and core may be recommended in selected cases after root canal treatment to help retain the foundation on which the final crown is placed.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, treatment is planned according to the remaining tooth structure, root condition and the restoration needed to protect the tooth.

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What Are the Post and Core and How Do They Work?

A post and core has two main parts, each with a specific purpose.

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Metal Post

A small metal post placed inside the prepared root canal of a suitable root-treated tooth. Its main purpose is to help retain the core when there is not enough natural tooth structure remaining.

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Core:

The built-up portion that replaces missing tooth structure and creates a foundation for the final crown.

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Dental Crown

A custom-made covering that is placed over the restored tooth when indicated, helping restore its shape and function.

A post does not automatically strengthen a tooth or make every damaged tooth suitable for restoration. The amount of healthy tooth structure remaining is an important part of treatment planning.

When Might a Metal Post Be Recommended?

A metal post may be considered when a tooth has undergone root canal treatment and has lost a substantial amount of its upper structure.

Common situations include:

- Extensive damage caused by deep tooth decay

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- A tooth that has broken down significantly

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- Insufficient remaining structure to retain a core restoration

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- A tooth that needs a crown but requires additional retention for the core

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Not every root canal-treated tooth needs a post. If enough healthy tooth structure remains, a post may not be necessary. The condition of the root and the supporting tissues must also be assessed before treatment.

How Is a Metal Post and Core Placed?

The procedure is planned carefully to preserve as much healthy tooth structure as possible.

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1. Tooth Assessment

The dentist examines the tooth and may take an X-ray to assess the root, previous root canal treatment and remaining tooth structure.

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2. Post Placement

When appropriate, space is carefully prepared within the root canal while preserving the root filling seal, and the metal post is secured in position.

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3. Core Build-Up

A core material is used to rebuild the missing upper portion of the tooth and provide a foundation for the planned restoration.

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4. Final Crown

A crown may then be placed to restore the tooth's shape, appearance and function, depending on the clinical plan.

The number of visits depends on the type of post, the condition of the tooth and the final restoration required.

What Results Can You Expect?

When the tooth is suitable for restoration, a post and core can help retain the core and support the planned crown. The aim is to preserve the existing tooth where possible rather than remove it simply because a large portion has been damaged.

Potential benefits include:

- Helps retain a core when little natural tooth structure remains
- Provides a foundation for a planned crown
- May allow a suitable damaged tooth to be restored
- Helps restore the tooth's shape and chewing function when combined with an appropriate final restoration

Aftercare & Protecting Your Restored Tooth

A restored tooth still needs regular care. The post does not eliminate the risk of fracture, decay or problems around the root.

- Brush twice daily and clean between your teeth.

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- Follow your dentist's instructions while waiting for the final crown.

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- Avoid biting hard objects with a temporary restoration.

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- Attend scheduled reviews to monitor the tooth and surrounding gums.

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- Seek a dental assessment if the tooth becomes painful, the restoration loosens or swelling develops.

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is a metal post in dentistry?

A metal post is a small support placed inside the root canal of a suitable root-treated tooth to help retain the core restoration.

2. Does every root canal-treated tooth need a post?

No. A post is considered when there is insufficient remaining tooth structure to retain the core. Some teeth can be restored without one.

3. Is placing a metal post painful?

The procedure is performed with appropriate pain-control measures. Your dentist will explain what to expect based on the condition of the tooth and the treatment required.

4. Will I need a crown after the post and core?

A crown is often considered to protect and restore a significantly damaged tooth, but the final restoration depends on the tooth's condition and clinical assessment.

5. How long does a metal post and core last?

There is no fixed lifespan. Longevity depends on the remaining tooth structure, root health, bite forces, the final crown and ongoing oral care.

6. Can a metal post cause a root fracture?

A post can place stress on the remaining root, and a structurally compromised tooth may be at risk of fracture. Careful case selection and conservative preparation are important.

7. What happens if the tooth cannot be restored?

If the root is severely damaged or the tooth has inadequate support, a post and core may not be suitable. Your dentist will discuss other options based on the examination.

Restore and Protect Your Tooth at Jerush

A badly damaged tooth may still be suitable for restoration, depending on the health of its root and the amount of natural structure remaining. At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, our dental team assesses each case and explains suitable restorative options before treatment.

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Ready to restore your tooth? Book a dental consultation with Jerush.